

The rules of “knight’s watch”

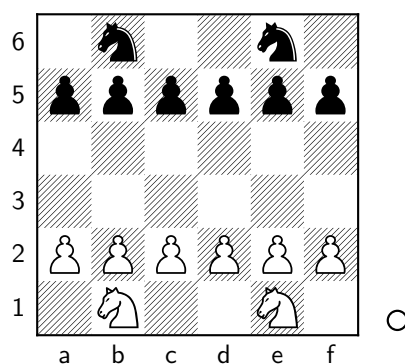
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1 Overview

This game plays on a chessboard using chess pieces. The board size is reduced to 6×6 and the only two pieces used are the pawn ♙ and the knight ♞. The object of the game is to get a single pawn across the board to one of the cells of the opponent’s *wall*.

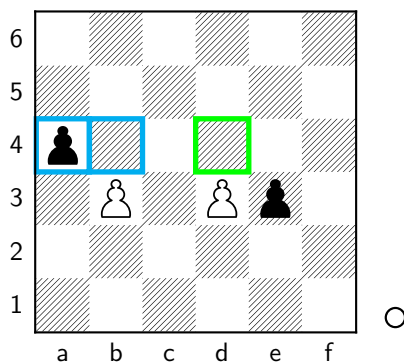
The initial board setup for “knight’s watch” is:



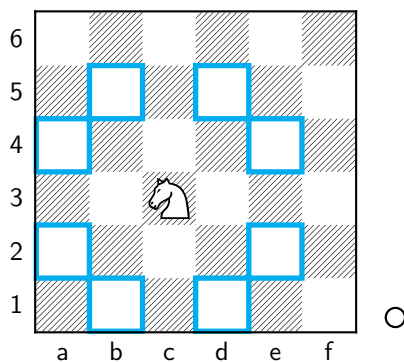
The dot on the right side of the board indicates the current color to move. Row 6 is black’s wall and row 1 is white’s.

2 Movement

Pawn. The pawn can move as they do in chess: only forward unless capturing, which can only be done diagonally forward¹. In the following, the pawn in column **b** may move to any blue square and the pawn in column **d** to the green square:



Knight. The knight moves as they do in the chess, in an “L” shape, without any exceptions. For example, in the following turn, the knight may move to any blue squares and capture any piece on that square.

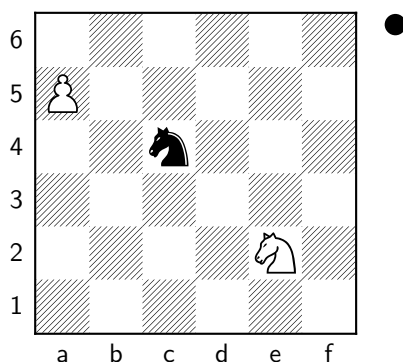


¹Unlike chess, in this game there is no *en passant* moves for pawns.

3 Winning

A game is over if one pawn reaches the opponent's wall, resulting in a win for that player. If all pawns on the board are captured, the game is a *draw*. Note that capturing all the opponents pawns does not immediately constitute a victory, though if all the opponents pieces are captured (both pawns and knights) without a draw, then the player wins by default.

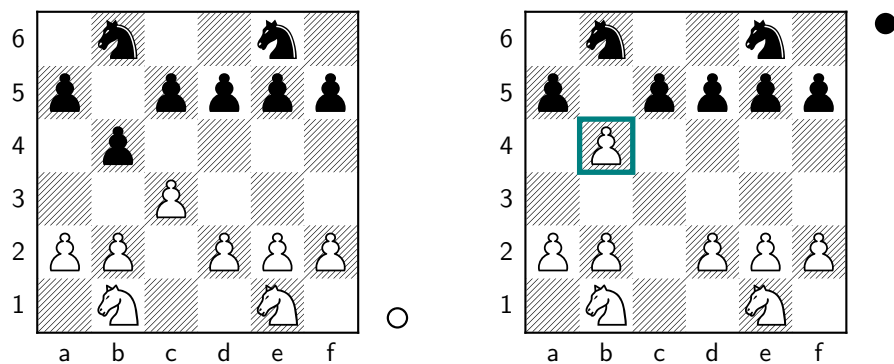
For example, assuming black makes the logical move, the following is a draw:



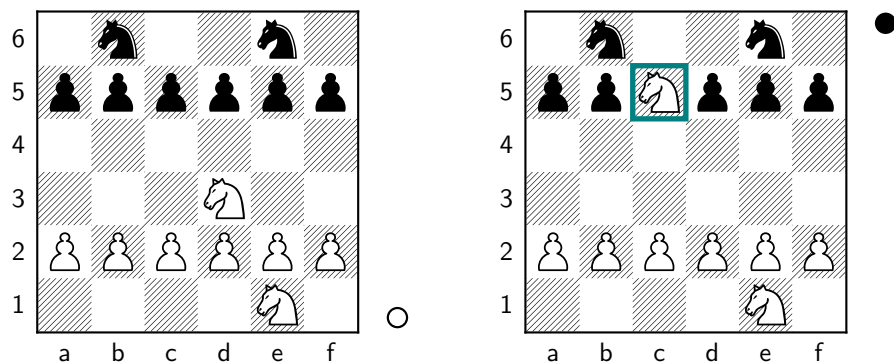
4 Notation

Just like chess, the game moves will have a lettered notation to represent moves. The board rows are numbered 1-6 and the columns a-f. Each board position is referenced by writing column letter followed by the row number. For example b4, a6 and f1. A move *string* contains first a piece to move, it's starting position and it's final position. Pawns are indicated by the letter P and knights by K.

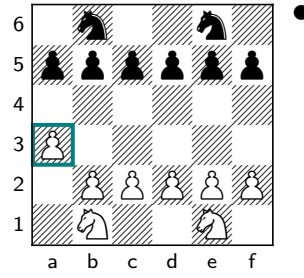
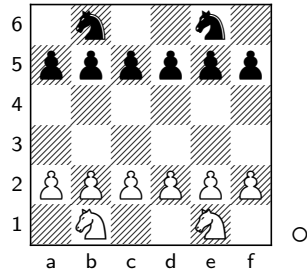
For example, Pc3b4 represents moving a pawn from c3 to b4, which must be a capture move:



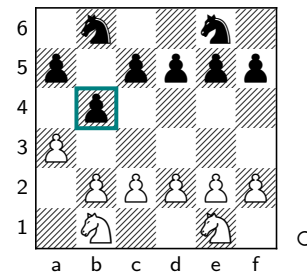
The string Kd3c5 represents moving a knight from d3 to c5:



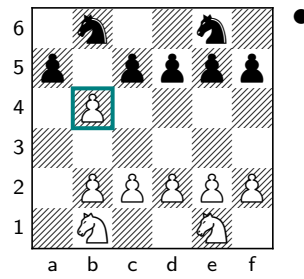
5 Sample Game



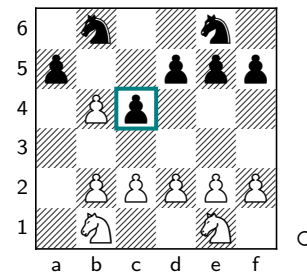
Pa2a3



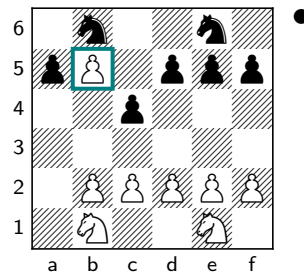
Pb5b4



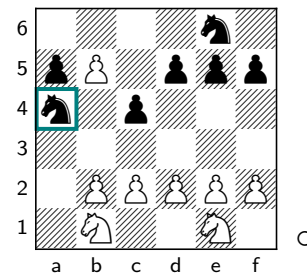
Pa3b4



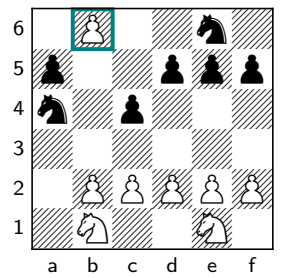
Pc5c4



Pb4b5



Kb6a4



Pb5b6